

CASE STUDY #4 — TELECOM

MobiWave's Postpaid Billing Nightmare

Billing Transformation & Customer Churn

Introduction

MobiWave, a regional telecom operator, launched a new bundled postpaid plan combining mobile data, home broadband, and OTT streaming subscriptions. Within weeks, the company's churn rate spiked from 2% to 6% monthly.

Background

Customer care was overwhelmed with billing disputes — customers were being charged incorrectly for bundles, some were double-billed for OTT add-ons, and others couldn't get their loyalty discounts applied. The issue traced back to gaps in MobiWave's BSS architecture: the product catalog wasn't updated to define the new bundle as a single rateable product, the mediation layer was dropping or duplicating usage records, CRM was not synced with billing, and revenue-assurance reconciliation was a manual weekly batch process rather than continuous monitoring.

Approach: BSS Concepts Applied

BSS Function	Issue Identified	Fix Implemented
Product Catalog / Order Management	New bundle not modeled correctly as one product	Redesigned catalog with bundle-level rating rules
Mediation & Rating	Usage data duplication/loss across sources	Implemented unified mediation layer with deduplication logic
Convergent Billing	Fragmented billing across services	Migrated to a single convergent billing engine
CRM Integration	Care agents lacked real-time billing visibility	Integrated CRM with billing via APIs for a single customer view
Revenue Assurance	Manual, delayed reconciliation	Automated real-time reconciliation with exception alerts
Self-Care Channels	Outdated bill representation	Synced self-care app with new billing engine

Resolution & Outcome

MobiWave rebuilt its product catalog for accurate bundle rating, deployed a unified mediation and convergent billing platform, and integrated CRM with billing for a single customer view. Within two months:

- Billing-related complaints dropped by 60%
- Monthly churn returned to 2.3%
- Revenue leakage from billing errors reduced by an estimated 15%

Final Note

The billing nightmare was a product-modeling problem before it was a technology problem: treating a genuinely bundled offer as three disconnected line items broke every downstream system that touched it. Fixing the catalog at the source resolved the churn and complaint spike.

Questions for Discussion

- Why did a product-design decision (how the bundle was modeled in the catalog) cascade into billing, CRM, and revenue-assurance failures simultaneously?
- What would a pre-launch testing process have needed to catch this before the bundle went live?

- How should MobiWave prevent similar issues the next time it launches a multi-service bundle?